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Election 2022: LA County Democrats hold on to Assembly seats, but GOP leading in north county races

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Voters in two-dozen state Assembly districts across Los Angeles County headed to the polls on Tuesday, Nov. 8, the final day to cast ballots in the 2022 statewide general election.

The districts span everything from the eastern edges of the county, where Pomona bridges the Inland Empire, to the coast.

The polls closed at 8 p.m. Tuesday. The first batch of returns — composed entirely of vote-by-mail ballots that arrived before Election Day — comprised the early results. And from there, during the official canvass, outstanding ballots will be counted — including all vote-by-mail ballots, conditional and provisional ballots.

Below is a roundup of the Assembly races that involve LA County, based on returns posted by Wednesday morning by the California Secretary of State. For districts entirely within LA County, the L.A. County Registrar's office released the semi-official results shortly before 4 a.m. Wednesday. The county registrar will next update the results on Friday, Nov. 11. Results will be certified by Dec. 16.

34th District: This district's area is immense, stretching over two counties, from Lancaster and Palmdale to Barstow. Republican Assemblymen Tom Lackey and Thurston Smith have both espoused conservative principals as they vie for a district the two lawmakers now share because of redistricting. In early results, Lackey was leading with 57.5% of the vote over Smith's 42.5%.

39th District: This newly redrawn district stretches from Palmdale to Victorville, where Democrat and Palmdale Councilman Juan Carrillo and Republican Paul Marsh, who served in the U.S. Army, are competing against each other. Carrillo's was up 54.6% to Marsh's 45.4%.

40th District: Assemblywoman Suzette Martinez Valladares, a rising star in Republican circles, is getting a serious challenge from Democrat Pilar Schiavo, a Chatsworth resident who has not held an elected position. They are vying to represent a district that encompasses the northern end of the San Fernando Valley north to Santa Clarita. Schiavo had 45.7% to Valladares' 54.3%.

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41st District: Chris Holden, a locally well-known Assembly Democrat, is being challenged by Republican Michael McMahon, who lacks political experience and has instead leaned on his law enforcement experience. The district hugs the foothill communities of the San Gabriels. In early results, Holden was up 57.1% of the vote to 42.9.% for McMahon.

42nd District: This district straddles L.A. and Ventura counties, encompassing Agoura Hills, Simi Valley and Moorpark. Assemblywoman Jacqui Irwin, a Democrat and an engineer by training, is being challenged by Republican businesswoman Lori Mills. In early results, Irwin had 54.2% of the vote to 45.8%.

43rd District: Assemblywoman Luz Rivas, D-Arleta, is looking for a third term representing a sizable chunk of the San Fernando Valley — including Pacoima, Lake View Terrace and Sunland-Tujunga — against Republican Siaka Massaquoi, a small business owner and entertainment industry "veteran." It was Rivas leading, with 70.2% to 29.8% for Massaquoi

44th District: Democratic Assemblywoman Laura Friedman is hoping to continue her work in the newly drawn 44th District, which will encompass Sherman Oaks on the west to Glendale on the east. Barry Curtis Jacobsen, a Republican, former Green Beret and small business owner, is seeking to unseat her. Friedman was up with 66.3% to 33.7% for Jacobsen.

46th District: Democratic incumbent Jesse Gabriel and Republican challenger Dana Caruso, a retired LAUSD educator and assistant principal, are going head to head in an area of the San Fernando Valley that stretches from Encino to Canoga Park. Gabriel was up 66.3% to Caruso's 39.7%.

48th District: Democratic Assemblywoman Blanca Rubio is being challenged by Ryan Maye, a Republican who says it's time for a change. The district stretches from West Covina to Glendora. Rubio was up 55.9% to Maye's 44.1% of the vote.

49th District: Assemblyman Mike Fong, who won a special election earlier this year to fill the seat left vacant by fellow Democrat Ed Chau, is going against Republican Burton Brink. The district includes Monterey Park, El Monte and Arcadia. In early results, Fong was up 62.2% over Brink's 37.8%.

51st District: In this newly drawn district, there are fresh faces running — both from the left. Democrats Louis Abramson and Rick Chavez Zbur are vying for a district seat that stretches from Santa Monica to Hollywood. Abramson was up 45.1% to Zbur's 54.9%.

52nd District: Democrats Mia Livas Porter, a parent and environmental advocate, and incumbent Wendy Carrillo, who was elected to the Assembly in 2017, are vying for this majority Latino voting district that encompasses Highland Park, parts of Glendale, Echo Park and Lincoln Heights. Carrillo had 60.3% of the vote to Porter's 39.7%.

53rd District: The winner of this race will represent a district that bridges eastern L.A. County with western San Bernardino County, from Pomona to Ontario. Assemblyman Freddie Rodriguez is putting his Democratic credentials up against Republican Toni Holle. Results showed Rodriguez up with 57.8% of the vote to Holle's 42.2%.

54th District: This heavily Latino voter majority district extends from Boyle Heights on the west to Montebello on the east. Assemblyman Miguel Santiago was first elected to the Assembly in 2014 to represent the then-53rd District. Elaine Alaniz wants to unseat him. In early results, Santiago had 74.3% of the vote to Alaniz's 25.7%.

55th District: Democratic incumbent Isaac Bryan wants to maintain his tenure in the Assembly against Keith Cascio, a Mar Vista Republican who laments government spending. The district stretches from Playa Vista through Culver City to Park La Brea. In early results, Bryan was leading with 80.1% of the vote to Cascio's 19.9%.

56th District: Democratic incumbent Lisa Calderon, who currently represents District 57 and is seeking a second

term, is again facing off against Republican Jessica Martinez, a Whittier councilwoman. The newly redrawn 56th District includes Diamond Bar, El Monte, the City of Industry, La Habra Heights, La Puente, Pico Rivera, South El Monte, Walnut and Whittier, as well as the unincorporated areas of Avocado Heights, Hacienda Heights, Los Angeles, Rowland Heights and West Whittier-Los Nietos. In early results, Calderon was up 54.1% to Martinez's 45.9%.

57th District: Assemblyman Reggie Jones-Sawyer is a Democrat running unopposed on the ballot for the district, which represents a swath of South Los Angeles.

61st District: Democratic Assemblywoman Tina Simone McKinnor is essentially running unopposed after Lawndale Mayor Robert Pullen-Miles dropped out and endorsed his opponent, though he will still be on the ballot. This district stretches from LAX to Westmonth and Athens, and from Inglewood to Hawthorne. McKinnor was up early, with 60.9% of the vote to 39.1%

62nd District: Assembly Speaker Anthony Rendón, who currently represents District 63, is facing fellow Democrat Maria Estrada for the newly drawn 62nd District, which includes Bell, Maywood, part of Long Beach and Lakewood. Rendon was up with 63.2% of the vote to Estrada's 36.8%.

64th District: Downey Mayor Blanca Pacheco, a Democrat, is running against Republican Raul Ortiz Jr. to represent a district that stretches from Bell and Bell Gardens through Downey and Norwalk and into La Mirada and the Orange County city of La Habra. In early results, Pacheco was up 61.7% to Ortiz Jr.'s 38.3%.

65th District: Incumbent Mike Anthony Gispon is being challenged by fellow Democrat Fatima Iqbal-Zubair in this district that stretches from San Pedro through West Carson and into Compton and Willowbrook. Latino voters make up the majority of voters in this district, but African Americans voters are also robust in number. Gibson was up early with 64.4% of the vote to 35.6%.

66th District: Democratic Assemblyman Al Muratsuchi is being challenged by Republican George Barks, a former Hermosa Beach councilman and mayor, for the right to represent a district that comprises Hermosa Beach, Manhattan Beach and Redondo Beach, Torrance and Rancho Palos Verdes. Muratsuchi was leading, with 55.5% to 44.5% for Barks.

67th District: The district bridges L.A. and Orange counties, from Artesia and Cerritos to Buena Park and Cypress. Democratic incumbent Sharon Quirk-Silva is going up against Republican Soo Yoo, who is a school board president. Quirk-Silva had 49.7% to Soo Yoo's 50.3%.

69th District: Long Beach Councilman Al Austin and small business owner Josh Lowenthal, both Democrats, are running for to represent a district that stretches from Long Beach to Carson. In early results, Lowenthal was off to a lead with 59.9% of the vote to 40.1% for Austin.

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